

# Epistemic Motion Analysis — Pair 0063

## Metadata

**Semantic Pair ID:** gibson\_sp063  
**Battery Version:** 3.0  
**Model:** gpt-oss:20b  
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## Turn Pair

### Question (MS. EASTERLING):

And your opinions in that case were -- were they blaming the plaintiff for the incident? (MR. GRINNAN objection: object to the form, foundation.)

### Answer (BENJAMIN GIBSON):

I don't think it was necessarily blaming the plaintiff in that case. I think it was noting that Energy Transfer was not involved in that work. They hired that contractor. They -- this guy was the foreman and had chose the means and method, that was more the theme in that case for -- given the nuances of that specific matter.

## Analysis

### Call 1 Epistemic Object

*transformation:*

#### Answer:

clarified blame focus

**Reasoning:** The witness moved from a vague notion of blame to a specific clarification that the plaintiff was not being blamed, shifting the focus to contractor responsibility.

#### Evidence:

- I don't think it was necessarily blaming the plaintiff in that case.

*object\_of\_transformation:*

#### Answer:

plaintiff blame attribution

**Reasoning:** The core concept being addressed and redefined was whether the plaintiff was being blamed in the case.

#### Evidence:

- And your opinions in that case were -- were they blaming the plaintiff for the incident?

*scaffolding:*

#### Answer:

**turn\_1\_scaffolding:** blame question framing **turn\_2\_scaffolding:** clarification of contractor **emergent\_support:** clarifying responsibility focus

**Reasoning:** Turn 1's scaffold was the question of blame; Turn 2's scaffold clarified contractor involvement; together they produced a clearer focus on responsibility.

**Evidence:**

- And your opinions in that case were
- They hired that contractor.

## Call 2 Epistemic Mechanics

*t1\_to\_t2\_relationship:*

**Answer:**

Turn 1 posed a specific blame question and introduced an objection, which constrained Gibson to address the blame issue and the objection, while enabling him to provide context about Energy Transfer and contractor responsibilities.

**Reasoning:** The question explicitly asked if the opinions blamed the plaintiff, forcing Gibson to clarify that they did not. The objection to form also required him to address foundation concerns. These constraints allowed him to explain that Energy Transfer was not involved and that the foreman chose the means and method.

**Evidence:**

- And your opinions in that case were -- were they blaming the plaintiff for the incident?
- I don't think it was necessarily blaming the plaintiff in that case.

*t2\_to\_t1\_relationship:*

**Answer:**

Gibson's reply reframes the question by shifting focus from blame to operational responsibility, revealing that the original premise of blame was incorrect and redirecting the inquiry to Energy Transfer's role.

**Reasoning:** Instead of simply affirming blame, Gibson states it was not blaming the plaintiff and explains the contractor's role. This recontextualizes the question, showing the question was misdirected. It also reveals that the question was too broad.

**Evidence:**

- I don't think it was necessarily blaming the plaintiff in that case.
- They hired that contractor.

*alignment\_bidirectional:*

**Answer:**

**t1\_to\_t2:** 2.5 **t2\_to\_t1:** 2.5

**Reasoning:** Gibson largely aligns with the blame question, directly addressing it, but also expands with context. The question is answered while adding nuance, so alignment is moderate to strong in both directions.

**Evidence:**

- And your opinions in that case were -- were they blaming the plaintiff for the incident?
- I don't think it was necessarily blaming the plaintiff in that case.

## Call 3 Epistemic Consequences

*constraints\_operationalized:*

**Answer:**

**constraint\_class:** Objection **constraint\_type:** Form **constrained:** question **constraint\_class:** Objection  
**constraint\_type:** Foundation **constrained:** opinion

**Reasoning:** The objection by Mr. Grinnan limits the question's form and the admissibility of the opinion, narrowing what can be asked and answered.

**Evidence:**

- object to the form, foundation

*enablements\_created:*

**Answer:**

**enablement\_class:** Clarification **enablement\_type:** Blame **enabled:** opinion **enablement\_class:** Responsibility

**enablement\_type:** Contractor **enabled:** foreman **enablement\_class:** Context **enablement\_type:** Energy Transfer  
**enabled:** involvement

**Reasoning:** Gibson's answer opens up new lines of inquiry about who was responsible and how the incident was framed, allowing the plaintiffs to explore liability beyond the plaintiff.

**Evidence:**

- I don't think it was necessarily blaming the plaintiff
- Energy Transfer was not involved
- They hired that contractor

*epistemic\_encoding:*

**Answer:**

**turn\_1: explicit:** • blaming plaintiff • incident • objection • form • foundation **implicit:** • opinion • attorney strategy • defendant perspective **turn\_2: explicit:** • not blaming plaintiff • Energy Transfer • contractor hired • foreman • means and method • theme **implicit:** • responsibility • liability • case context • opinion interpretation

**Reasoning:** The question explicitly names blame and legal objections, while Gibson's reply explicitly names parties and actions but implicitly conveys responsibility and liability.

**Evidence:**

- And your opinions in that case were -- were they blaming the plaintiff for the incident?
- I don't think it was necessarily blaming the plaintiff in that case.

## Call 4 Epistemic Geometry

*convergence:*

**Answer:**

**present:** partial **mechanism:** • partial alignment **prevented\_by:** • additional nuance

**Reasoning:** The question directly asked whether the witness's opinions blamed the plaintiff. Gibson partially agreed, saying it was not necessarily blaming the plaintiff, while adding contextual details. This shows a partial alignment of frames with added nuance.

**Evidence:**

- And your opinions in that case were -- were they blaming the plaintiff for the incident?
- I don't think it was necessarily blaming the plaintiff in that case.

*divergence:*

**Answer:**

**present:** partial **mechanism:** • shift focus **prevented\_by:** • question framing

**Reasoning:** Gibson introduced new focus on Energy Transfer and the contractor, moving away from the original blame frame. This shift indicates a partial divergence between the question's intent and the witness's response.

**Evidence:**

- I think it was noting that Energy Transfer was not involved in that work.

*emergence:*

**Answer:**

**present:** false **mechanism:** None **prevented\_by:** None

**Reasoning:** The additional content about Energy Transfer and the contractor was supplied by the witness alone and did not arise from the interaction itself. Therefore no emergent structure is present.

**Evidence:**

- They hired that contractor. They -- this guy was the foreman and had chose the means and method, that was more the theme in that case for -- given the nuances of that specific matter.

## Call 5 Epistemic Trajectory

*change\_in\_understanding:*

**Answer:**

**turn\_1\_now\_understands:** • not blaming plaintiff • Energy Transfer not involved • foreman choice

**turn\_2\_now\_understands:** • question about blame • clarified no blame • contractor focus

**Reasoning:** Ms. Easterling now understands that Gibson's opinions did not blame the plaintiff and that Energy Transfer was not involved, focusing on the contractor and foreman. Gibson realizes the question was about blame and clarifies that he did not blame the plaintiff, highlighting the contractor and foreman's role.

**Evidence:**

- And your opinions in that case were -- were they blaming the plaintiff for the incident?
- I don't think it was necessarily blaming the plaintiff in that case.

*what\_matters:*

**Answer:**

**object:** blaming plaintiff **trajectory: 1 object:** Energy Transfer involvement **trajectory: 1 object:** contractor hired

**trajectory: 1 object:** foreman choice **trajectory: 1 object:** means and method theme **trajectory: 1**

**Reasoning:** The key elements of blame, Energy Transfer involvement, contractor hiring, foreman choice, and means and method theme are all central to the discussion and thus carry forward.

**Evidence:**

- I don't think it was necessarily blaming the plaintiff in that case.
- They hired that contractor.

*meaning\_generated:*

**Answer:**

**meaning\_object:** blame **now\_possible:** shifted focus **meaning\_object:** contractor **now\_possible:** role clarified

**meaning\_object:** foreman **now\_possible:** decision role

**Reasoning:** The exchange opens the possibility to discuss blame, contractor role, and foreman decision making in more detail.

**Evidence:**

- I don't think it was necessarily blaming the plaintiff in that case.
- They hired that contractor.

## Meta-Pattern

### Declaration: Blame Shift

**Reasoning:** Across all lenses the exchange moves from an initial focus on blaming the plaintiff to a clarified stance that no blame is directed at the plaintiff and responsibility is shifted to the contractor and foreman. The two words capture this core shift in attribution.